

LUCIDPREP

Grade 8 United States History I

U.S. Standards-Aligned Course Syllabus

UNITED STATES HISTORY I

U.S. History I • to 1877

36 weeks • 4 modules • 70% mastery

Curriculum Architecture

This course is organized as 36 weeks across four 9-week modules. Every week follows LucidPrep's established secondary learning cycle: AI Instructor opening, objectives, vocabulary, five warm-ups, main lecture, two short tutorial videos, AI Instructor presentation, two homework sets, and a 40-question assessment.

Mastery standard: 70%+. Students below mastery review the instructional presentation and may retake the assessment, matching the existing LucidPrep secondary model.

U.S. Alignment Note

Social studies has no single national standard; the C3 Framework guides most state standards, paired here with Common Core literacy standards for history/social studies. United States History (colonization to Reconstruction) is the most common Grade 8 social studies course nationwide, though some states divide the U.S. survey differently.

Prepared for LucidPrep • Curriculum Planning Edition • 2026

Common Instructional & Assessment Model

Weekly Learning Cycle

Step	Component	Description
1	Opening / Domain Overview	~2-minute AI Instructor introduction
2	Objectives + Vocabulary	Student-facing outcomes and core terminology
3	Warm-Up	5 questions with explanations
4	Main Lecture	Concept instruction, models and examples
5	Video Tutorials	2 short instructional videos
6	AI Instructor Presentation	Visual models, examples, strategies and applications
7	Homework	Two sets of 5 questions
8	Weekly Assessment	40 questions; 70% mastery
9	Review / Retake	Below mastery → review presentation → retake

Assessment Philosophy

Assessment is continuous and mastery-based. Each week pairs low-stakes practice (five warm-ups and two homework sets) with a 40-question weekly assessment. Students scoring below 70% review the instructional presentation and retake, so mastery is reached before progressing. Module assessments at Weeks 9, 18 and 27 and a cumulative final at Week 36 measure retention and synthesis.

UNITED STATES HISTORY I

Grade 8 U.S. History
(Colonization to Reconstruction)
aligned to the C3 Framework and
Common Core literacy standards

This 36-week course is designed around **the C3 Framework (with a history emphasis) and the Common Core literacy standards for history/social studies (RH.6-8, WHST.6-8)**. It is a full-year curriculum with four nine-week modules and a consistent LucidPrep mastery workflow.

Grade	Grade 8
Course	U.S. History I • to 1877
Duration	36 weeks
Structure	4 modules × 9 weeks
Weekly assessment	40 questions
Mastery threshold	70%
Module assessments	Weeks 9, 18, 27
Final assessment	Week 36

Course Learning Outcomes

- Analyze the founding and development of the United States to 1877.
- Explain the origins and principles of American government.
- Evaluate causes and effects of expansion, conflict and reform.
- Analyze the causes, course and consequences of the Civil War and Reconstruction.
- Use primary sources and evidence to construct historical arguments.

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Module 1 — Foundations & Colonial America

Week	Topics	Students will be able to	Standards
1 — The Historian's Toolkit	Sources, chronology, evidence	Analyze historical sources	C3 D1/D3; RH.6-8.1
2 — Indigenous Peoples of North America	Diverse cultures before contact	Describe Indigenous societies	C3 D2 His
3 — Exploration & Encounter	European exploration; the Columbian Exchange	Analyze exploration and its effects	C3 D2 His/Geo
4 — Colonial Settlement	New England, Middle and Southern colonies	Compare the colonial regions	C3 D2 His/Econ
5 — Colonial Society & Economy	Labor, slavery, daily life	Analyze colonial society and economy	C3 D2 Econ
6 — Slavery & the Atlantic World	Transatlantic slave trade; resistance	Analyze slavery in the colonies	C3 D2 His
7 — Self-Government & Ideas	Representative assemblies; Enlightenment ideas	Explain the roots of self-government	C3 D2 Civ
8 — Road to Revolution	Taxation, tensions, protest	Analyze the causes of the Revolution	C3 D2 His/Civ
9 — Module 1 Assessment	Cumulative review of colonial America	Demonstrate mastery of Module 1	C3 D2

Module delivery notes. Anchor units in primary sources and an inquiry arc. Emphasize causation, continuity and change, and multiple perspectives from the founding through Reconstruction.

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Module 2 — Revolution & the New Nation

Week	Topics	Students will be able to	Standards
1 — The American Revolution	Declaration, war, key events	Analyze the Revolution	C3 D2 His
2 — Founding Ideals	Liberty and equality in the Declaration	Analyze founding ideals	C3 D2 Civ
3 — Articles of Confederation	The first government and its weaknesses	Evaluate the Articles of Confederation	C3 D2 Civ
4 — Constitutional Convention	Compromises and structure	Explain the Constitution's creation	C3 D2 Civ
5 — Constitution & Federalism	Separation of powers; checks and balances	Explain constitutional principles	C3 D2 Civ
6 — The Bill of Rights	Ratification debate; rights	Analyze the Bill of Rights	C3 D2 Civ
7 — The New Government	Washington, precedents, political parties	Analyze the early republic	C3 D2 Civ/His
8 — Early Challenges	Foreign affairs, Marshall Court, identity	Analyze early national challenges	C3 D2 His
9 — Module 2 Assessment	Cumulative review of the new nation	Demonstrate mastery of Module 2	C3 D2 Civ

Module delivery notes. Anchor units in primary sources and an inquiry arc. Emphasize causation, continuity and change, and multiple perspectives from the founding through Reconstruction.

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Module 3 — Expansion & Reform

Week	Topics	Students will be able to	Standards
1 — Jefferson & the Louisiana Purchase	Expansion begins	Analyze early expansion	C3 D2 His/Geo
2 — War of 1812 & Nationalism	Causes, effects, national growth	Analyze the War of 1812	C3 D2 His
3 — Jacksonian Democracy	Expanded suffrage; Indian Removal	Evaluate Jacksonian democracy	C3 D2 Civ
4 — Westward Expansion & Manifest Destiny	Migration; the Mexican-American War	Analyze westward expansion	C3 D2 His/Geo
5 — Industrial & Market Revolution	Technology, economy, immigration	Analyze economic transformation	C3 D2 Econ
6 — Slavery & Sectionalism	North vs South economies; tensions	Analyze growing sectionalism	C3 D2 Econ/His
7 — Reform Movements	Abolition, women's rights, education	Analyze antebellum reform	C3 D2 Civ
8 — Toward Disunion	Compromises, Dred Scott, election of 1860	Analyze the causes of secession	C3 D2 His/Civ
9 — Module 3 Assessment	Cumulative review of expansion and reform	Demonstrate mastery of Module 3	C3 D2 His

Module delivery notes. Anchor units in primary sources and an inquiry arc. Emphasize causation, continuity and change, and multiple perspectives from the founding through Reconstruction.

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Module 4 — Civil War & Reconstruction

Week	Topics	Students will be able to	Standards
1 — Secession & War Begins	Fort Sumter, sides, resources	Analyze the outbreak of war	C3 D2 His
2 — The Civil War	Major campaigns and turning points	Analyze the course of the war	C3 D2 His
3 — Emancipation	Emancipation Proclamation; Black soldiers	Analyze emancipation	C3 D2 His/Civ
4 — Home Front & Total War	Society, economy, the Gettysburg Address	Analyze the war's impact on society	C3 D2 His
5 — War's End & Costs	Surrender; Lincoln's assassination; consequences	Evaluate the war's outcomes	C3 D2 His
6 — Reconstruction Plans	Presidential vs congressional Reconstruction	Compare Reconstruction plans	C3 D2 Civ
7 — Reconstruction Amendments	13th, 14th and 15th Amendments	Analyze the Reconstruction amendments	C3 D2 Civ
8 — End of Reconstruction & Legacy	Compromise of 1877; Jim Crow; legacies	Evaluate Reconstruction's legacy	C3 D2 His/Civ
9 — Final Assessment	Cumulative final across all modules	Demonstrate mastery of the full course	C3 D1-D4

Module delivery notes. Anchor units in primary sources and an inquiry arc. Emphasize causation, continuity and change, and multiple perspectives from the founding through Reconstruction.

Assessment & Alignment

Assessment Blueprint

Warm-ups: weekly • Homework: weekly • Weekly assessment: 40 questions • Module assessments: Weeks 9 / 18 / 27 • Final: Week 36 • Below 70%: instructional review and retake.

Standards Alignment

Primary framework	C3 Framework (History emphasis); CCSS literacy RH.6-8 & WHST.6-8
Social Studies Practices	Developing questions and planning inquiries; applying disciplinary concepts and tools; evaluating sources and using evidence; communicating conclusions and taking informed action.
Recurring Concepts	Chronological and spatial reasoning; causation and change; multiple perspectives; evidence and interpretation; civic and economic reasoning.
State mapping	No single national social studies standard; the C3 Framework guides most state standards, and grade placement of specific courses varies widely by state.

Content Production Guidance

Author each week around primary sources and an inquiry question: 5 warm-ups, a lecture with sources and context, 2 videos, an AI presentation with maps/documents, 2 homework sets, and a 40-question bank blending content, source analysis and reasoning. Tag items to C3 and literacy standards.

Curriculum Basis & Source Notes

This Grade 8 social studies syllabus was generated from the C3 Framework and the Common Core literacy standards for history/social studies. It reflects U.S. History I · to 1877, a common Grade 8 course; grade placement of social studies courses varies widely by state.

Primary reference	C3 Framework for Social Studies State Standards (NCSS) — Dimensions 1–4.
Literacy standards	Common Core literacy standards for history/social studies (RH and WHST, grades 6–8).
State cross-check	Representative state standards (e.g., California, Texas, New York).
LucidPrep alignment	Mapped to LucidPrep's 36-week, 4-module structure with 70% mastery.

Recommended next production step. Select the primary-source set and inquiry questions per module, then commission item banks blending content, source analysis and reasoning, tagged to C3 and literacy standards.